CHAPTER 17

Tailoring the TOGAF Standard



This chapter is part of the GREEN, BLUE, and GOLD reading tours. See Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3, for alternative reading tours.

The TOGAF Standard is a framework with a high degree of flexibility and adaptability. The framework itself states in one of the first chapters that it should be adapted to the needs and requirements of the organization in which it is used. Several factors can play a role in determining the extent to which the framework needs to be adapted. These may include industry regulations, best practices, and compliance requirements, project scope and complexity, alignment with the organization's current maturity level, and specific modeling languages, tools, and techniques.

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17.1. Designed for Customization

Adapting the TOGAF Standard to one's own organization, to one's own needs and desires, and to the situation in which the organization finds itself is of great importance. There is a reason why adaptability is one of the first points mentioned in the framework.

The TOGAF Framework is designed to require interpretation or customization [18].

The framework can be modified in many areas. The most important parts and aspects are described below.

The adaptability of the Enterprise Metamodel and the Content Framework has already been discussed in detail in Chapter 5, Section 5.2, and in Chapter 6, Section 6.4, respectively. However, it does not hurt to review all the ways in which the framework can be customized.

The TOGAF Standard can be customized in the following ways:

- Tailoring for organizational context
- Tailoring the Architecture Development Method
- Tailoring the Content Framework and deliverables
- Tailoring governance and compliance
- Tailoring tools and techniques

Tailoring for Organizational Context: The framework's entities can be modified to better fit the organization's strategic goals and operating model. This allows for better alignment with business strategy.

The TOGAF Standard's Enterprise Metamodel (see Chapter 5) can also be adapted to specific industry regulations, best practices, and compliance requirements. This type of tailoring focuses on industry-specific adaptation.

A third way to tailor the framework to the organizational context is based on the size and structure of the organization. The TOGAF Standard can be easily customized for small, medium, or large organizations, taking into account centralization and decentralization.

A final way to customize the architecture framework is to tailor the governance and processes based on the organization's experience with architecture practices. This final approach aims to tailor the framework to an organization's culture and maturity level.

The essential scaffolding of the TOGAF Framework is the concepts. Everything else in the TOGAF Framework is either an example or a starter set to get you moving. If you do not like the example, then you can take advantage of the modular structure of the TOGAF Framework and substitute it [18].

Tailoring the Architecture Development Method: Depending on the scope of the project, some phases may be modified or even omitted. It is by no means necessary to go through all the phases of the Architecture Development Method for the sake of going through them. For example, if a project's scope is small enough that it doesn't require a new set of Architecture Principles, then it's possible to skip the corresponding Preliminary Phase steps. The same is true for a situation that does not require the creation of an architecture team. There is no need to go through all the necessary steps if a team already exists. Skipping or even reordering phases is entirely possible, as is combining phases where efficiencies can be gained (e.g., combining phases B, C, and D for a high-level architecture definition).

The Architecture Development Method also allows for integration with iterative or agile methodologies such as SAFe. It is even possible to include additional governance checkpoints to align with corporate governance structures. The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel method

described in Chapter 16, Section 16.2, is a great example of the flexibility and adaptability of the Architecture Development Method.

Tailoring the Content Framework and Deliverables: As discussed in Chapters 5 and 6, the Enterprise Metamodel and Content Framework can be easily aligned with the organization's proprietary data models. Architecture deliverables can be simplified (or expanded) to better match the organization's level of maturity in working with architecture. These base models can be aligned with ITIL, COBIT, the Zachman Framework, ArchiMate, or agile frameworks.

For example, certain ITIL processes can be added to the Content Framework as business functions or even capabilities. The same is true for parts of the COBIT framework. The TOGAF Standard can also be seamlessly integrated with ArchiMate, as was demonstrated in Chapter 5, Section 5.2, when the addition of the stakeholder to the Enterprise Metamodel entity was proposed.

Tailoring Governance and Compliance: If the organization uses specific policies, the governance structure of the TOGAF Standard can be modified to include these policies. Like the Risk Management or Stakeholder Management technique, these can be added to or implemented within the governance structure of the framework. The techniques provided can be tailored to the needs of the organization.

Tailoring Tools and Techniques: Finally, the TOGAF Standard allows for customization at the level of adoption of specific modeling languages, tools, and techniques. It is possible to use preferred tools such as ArchiMate, UML, BPMN, or even custom solutions to visualize the architecture artifacts that may be generated during the execution of the phases of the Architecture Development Method. In addition to using preferred modeling languages, the TOGAF Standard allows integration with Enterprise Architecture tools such as Bizzdesign or LeanIX.



Align with Organizational Goals: Start by aligning the framework's core components with the organization's strategic goals and operating model. This ensures that the Enterprise Architecture is not just a theoretical model, but a practical tool that moves the business forward.

Adapt to Industry Standards: Modify the Enterprise Metamodel to incorporate specific industry regulations, best practices, and compliance requirements. Tailoring the framework in this way helps the architecture remain relevant and compliant within the specific industry context.

Scale to the Size of the Organization: Tailor the framework to the size and structure of the organization, whether it's a small startup or a large organization. In large organizations, it may make sense to implement the architecture in its full breadth. Smaller organizations may be better off with only parts of the architecture. Therefore, only those parts of the TOGAF Standard that add value to the organization should be used. This flexibility ensures that the framework remains practical and effective regardless of the size or complexity of the organization.

Reflect the Maturity of the Organization: Adapt governance structures and processes based on the organization's experience and maturity with architecture practices. This approach aligns the framework with the organization's culture and readiness, facilitating smoother implementation and adoption.

Adjust the Architecture Development Method: Modify the phases of the Architecture Development Method to fit the scope of the project. It's acceptable to skip or combine phases as appropriate. This adaptability eliminates unnecessary work and enables a more efficient architecture development process.

Customize the Content Framework and Deliverables: Align the Content Framework with the organization's data models and existing entities. Simplify or extend deliverables based on the organization's maturity level. Customizing the content ensures that the architecture deliverables are relevant and manageable for the organization.

Change Governance and Compliance Structures: Incorporate the organization's specific policies into the architecture governance structure. Use techniques such as Risk Management and Stakeholder Management. This will ensure that the architecture framework supports and enhances the organization's governance and compliance efforts.

Select Appropriate Tools and Techniques: Select modeling languages and tools that match the organization's preferences, such as ArchiMate, UML, BPMN, or custom solutions. Integrate with Enterprise Architecture tools. Using familiar tools facilitates better visualization and management of architecture artifacts, leading to more effective implementation.

As described in the introduction to this book, many practitioners end up abandoning the framework. The main reason given for this is that the framework does not describe *how* it can be implemented. It focuses too much on describing *what* can be done. Another common argument against the use of the TOGAF Standard is that it lacks real-world examples that show how it can be used in practice.

As far as real-world examples are concerned, this can be directly refuted. The following section demonstrates the adaptability of the TOGAF Standard in a real-world situation.

17.2. Tailoring the TOGAF Standard for the Healthcare Industry

The steps outlined above for adapting the framework are fairly generic and therefore applicable to a wide range of sectors. To illustrate the high degree of adaptability of the TOGAF Standard, consider the need to adapt the framework to better meet the specific needs of the healthcare industry. The sector has unique challenges, including regulatory compliance, interoperability, patient data security, and rapidly evolving technology. Tailoring the TOGAF Standard for healthcare will require adjustments in several areas.

When developing an industry-specific metamodel, architects may choose not to include entities and relationships from the Enterprise Metamodel that are not relevant and/or add additional entities and relationships [2].

The various components of the TOGAF Standard that can be adapted were applied to the case study described below. For each part, the steps taken are described.

Tailoring for Healthcare-Specific Needs: To meet industry-specific needs, the framework can be aligned with standards such as HIPAA (US), GDPR (Europe), HL7 FHIR (interoperability standards), and ISO 13485 (medical devices)[1] to meet regulatory compliance requirements.

The Foundation Enterprise Metamodel can be augmented with industry-specific entities and a patient-centric focus. This leads to the modification of artifacts to incorporate *patient experience*, *electronic health records* (EHRs), and *digital health solutions*.

[1] ISO 13485 is the internationally recognized standard for quality management systems in the design and manufacture of medical devices. It outlines specific requirements that help organizations ensure their medical devices meet both customer and regulatory demands for safety and efficacy (https://www.iso.org/standard/59752.html).

Tailoring the framework to healthcare-specific needs ensures that the Enterprise Architecture supports both clinical workflow and hospital administration by achieving clinical and operational alignment.

Last but not least, the TOGAF Standard encourages its user to implement or even strengthen *information security architectures* to meet healthcare-specific threats and vulnerabilities.

Tailoring the Architecture Development Method: The healthcare industry requires rapid adaptation to new technologies (like telemedicine, AI diagnostics). Therefore, implementing an agile approach within the Architecture Development Method cycle allows the industry to respond quickly. It is quite possible to introduce what is called phase prioritization. This can be achieved by tailoring the Architecture Development Method to:

- **Emphasize Business Architecture** (Phase B) to map patient journeys, hospital workflows, and public health initiatives.
- **Strengthen Technology Architecture** (Phase D) to focus on cloud adoption, data lakes for research, and AI-driven diagnostics.
- **Enhance migration planning** (Phase F) to address legacy system modernization and EHR system upgrades.

Tailoring the Content Framework and Deliverables: The introduction of *FHIR-based data models*[2] for interoperability enables the development of a customized Content Framework for healthcare. This allows the use of tailored deliverables by leveraging *clinical workflows* and *decision support systems* in Business Architecture models. Some of the key architecture deliverables to be customized are:

[2] The Fast Healthcare Interoperability Resources (FHIR) standard is a set of rules and specifications for the secure exchange of electronic healthcare data.

- **Capability Models:** These models enable the definition of hospital capabilities such as *telemedicine*, *remote patient monitoring*, and *AI diagnostics* (see
- **Interoperability Maps:** Ensure that EHR systems, lab systems, pharmacy management, and imaging systems (PACS/RIS) can communicate seamlessly.
- **Risk and Compliance Models:** Allow for addressing risks associated with data breaches, AI misdiagnosis, and critical care system downtime.

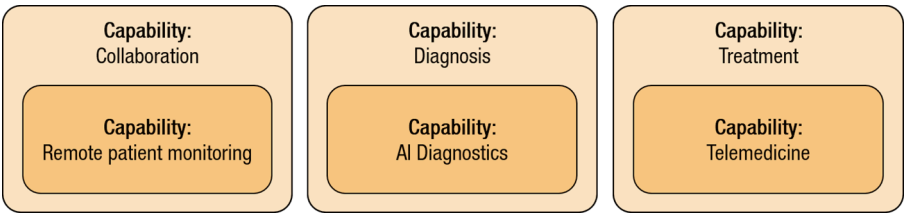


Figure 17-1. *Tailored industry-specific Business Capability Diagram*

Tailoring Governance and Compliance: The TOGAF Standard can also be adapted for healthcare-specific governance by establishing an Architecture Board that includes clinical representatives, IT security, and compliance officers. There are known situations where medical informatics and health IT experts have been included in and on the Architecture Board.

In addition, tailoring the governance and compliance structures of the TOGAF Standard allows an industry to consider implementing regulatory decision gates. These could include regulatory checkpoints such as HIPAA risk assessments or country-specific regulatory approvals for AI-driven diagnostics.

Tailoring Tools and Techniques: Use industry-specific Enterprise Architecture tools. For example, implement ArchiMate models with healthcare extensions and/or use FHIR-based interoperability testing

tools. Adopt data-driven decision-making by using AI-driven analytics in architecture modeling. Finally, introduce predictive modeling to optimize patient flow and resource allocation.

The example scenario described above demonstrates a fully tailored version of the TOGAF Standard. By customizing the framework for the healthcare industry, organizations can improve patient outcomes, ensure regulatory compliance, and enhance interoperability. The focus should be on security, interoperability, AI adoption, and cloud-based healthcare ecosystems. The TOGAF Standard's flexibility and adaptability makes everything possible.

17.3. Summary

Adapting the TOGAF Standard to the unique characteristics of an organization – its needs, ambitions, and operational context – is essential for achieving its intended value. Adaptability, prominently emphasized within the framework, serves as a foundational principle precisely for this reason.

The TOGAF Standard offers extensive opportunities for customization:

- **Tailoring for Organizational Context:** The framework's core components may be adapted to better align with the organization's strategic objectives and operational realities. This ensures a closer connection between Enterprise Architecture efforts and overarching business imperatives.
- **Tailoring the Architecture Development Method:** The phases of the Architecture Development Method can be selectively modified or omitted in accordance with

the specific scope and requirements of an initiative. Rigid adherence to all phases is neither prescribed nor necessary where it does not add value.

- **Tailoring the Content Framework and Deliverables:** The Enterprise Metamodel and Content Framework are designed to integrate seamlessly with proprietary data models. Furthermore, the complexity or simplicity of architecture deliverables can be adjusted to correspond with the organization's maturity level in Enterprise Architecture practices.
- **Tailoring Governance and Compliance Structures:** Where existing policies and regulatory frameworks are in place, the governance model outlined in the TOGAF Standard can be extended to incorporate these organizational-specific requirements.
- **Tailoring Tools and Techniques:** The selection and application of modeling languages, tools, and techniques may be customized, allowing organizations to adopt methods best suited to their operational environment and technological landscape.

The TOGAF Standard can provide a tailored solution for virtually any situation, scenario, organization, or industry by utilizing the customization options mentioned above.